



Route

My Winter Car v.260516-01

Alivieska, January 1999 — the ground is frozen solid

Modlist · Installation · Field Manual · Personas

Compiled August 2026 — My Winter Car v.260516-01 / MSCLoader v1.4.2

Table of Contents

1	Installation	4
1.1	What you need	4
1.2	Step 1 — Install and launch the game	4
1.3	Step 2 — Install the loader (the mod manager)	4
1.4	Step 3 — Install the mods, layer by layer	5
1.5	Step 4 — Verify the first launch	5
1.6	Updating and removing mods	5
1.7	Safety rules	6
2	The Modlist	6
2.1	The list at a glance	6
2.2	Design pillars	7
2.3	The mod manager: MSCLoader (for My Winter Car)	7
2.4	Layer 1 — “The Cold Start” (QoL & graphics)	7
2.4.1	Graphics	7
2.4.2	Quality of life	8
2.5	Layer 2 — “The Full Winter” (the full modded experience)	9
2.5.1	Detail & depth	9
2.6	What we deliberately left out	9
2.7	Download sources	10
3	How to Play	10
3.1	What the game actually is	10
3.2	The daily loop	11
3.3	Your first days in Alivieska	11
3.3.1	Day 1 — learn the house and the shop	11
3.3.2	Day 2–3 — get the Sorbet working	12
3.3.3	Day 4+ — buy the Rivett	12
3.3.4	Day 5+ — the taxi (once the Rivett is yours)	12
3.4	The economy: jobs and money	12
3.4.1	The taxi job, properly	12
3.5	Engineering: building the Rivett	13
3.5.1	The engine, assembly by assembly	13
3.5.2	Bolts, tools and the feel of the build	14
3.6	The cold start (the signature skill)	14
3.6.1	Oil, battery, and the redline	14
3.7	Winter driving	15
3.8	Inspection, racing and historic plates	15
3.9	Music, mail and small pleasures	15
3.10	The modded experience	15
3.11	Basic terms	16
3.12	Saves, backups & troubleshooting	17
3.13	How to get good (a checklist)	17
4	Personas	17
4.1	Before you start: how “game creation” works here	17

4.2	1. The Assembly Mechanic	18
4.3	2. The Taxi Man	18
4.4	3. The Factory Hand	19
4.5	4. The Ice Racer	19
4.6	5. The Hermit of Alivieska	20
4.7	How to start a persona run	20

1 Installation

From a vanilla *My Winter Car* v.260516-01 to a modded winter garage in four steps: game, loader, mods, verify.

1.1 What you need

Item	Value
Base game	My Winter Car v.260516-01 — Steam (Early Access; Amistech is still actively developing the game)
Mod manager	MSCLoader (for My Winter Car) v1.4.2 — the community-standard mod manager; every maintained mod on the hub depends on it
Mods	The curated Nexus mods from chapter 2, installed in two layers
Sources	Nexus Mods (My Winter Car hub) · the loader's GitHub wiki · the My Winter Car Wiki

My Winter Car is a **living game**: Amistech ships date-coded Early Access builds frequently (v.260126-01, v.260415-01, v.260504-01, v.260516-01 — and more after). Steam keeps the game on the latest build automatically, so there is no version selection to worry about — but a game update can briefly break a mod until its author catches up, so check each mod's **Last updated** date and **Posts** tab before installing.

Good to know

The two-layer structure exists for exactly this reason: **Layer 1** (QoL and graphics only) is how a fresh player starts. **Layer 2** (the full modded experience) is added once you have experience. Both are described in chapter 2. MSCLoader loads all installed mods and lets you **enable and disable each one** from its in-game mod menu — that is how the layers work here: enable the Layer 1 set first, then switch Rivett Revamp on for Layer 2.

1.2 Step 1 — Install and launch the game

1. Install **My Winter Car** from Steam (app 4164420).
2. Launch the game once and start a new game, so the game creates its save folder under %AppData%\LocalLow\Amistech\My Winter Car (savefile.txt for world state and jobs, carpart.txt for vehicle wear and tightness).
3. Quit and confirm the vanilla game runs before touching mods. If something is wrong, fix it first.

1.3 Step 2 — Install the loader (the mod manager)

Every maintained mod for My Winter Car is built for **MSCLoader** — the loader is the ecosystem: it provides the in-game mod menu, per-mod settings, update checking, conflict warnings and bug reports, and 497 mods on the Nexus hub depend on it. Install flow (from the loader's official README):

1. Download the latest **MSCLoader (for My Winter Car)** release — Nexus mods/3 or GitHub piotrułos/MSCModLoader/releases.
2. Unpack the archive **anywhere you like** — **do NOT unpack it into any game folders**.
3. Run **MSCLInstaller.exe**. If the My Winter Car path is not found automatically, select it manually.
4. Choose **Install MSCLoader** → **Select Option**, and pick your **Mods folder** — **Game Folder is recommended**.

5. Wait for the installation to finish. Launch the game once: you should see the loader's mod menu (the loader wiki shows the current keybind; a console window and `output_log.txt` / `MSCLoader_Preloaders.txt` next to the game's executable are normal).

Tip

The loader serves both My Summer Car and My Winter Car — use the **for My Winter Car** build from `mods/3` and the installer picks the right game. If the installer does not auto-detect the game, the community-documented workaround is to temporarily rename the game executable (`mywintercar.exe` → `mysummercar.exe`), run the installer, and rename it back — then verify the mod menu opens.

1.4 Step 3 — Install the mods, layer by layer

Every mod in this guide lives on the Nexus Mods My Winter Car hub. There is no separate download site and no external tool: download → unpack into the Mods folder → enable in the loader's mod menu.

1. Open the hub: nexusmods.com/mywintercar.
2. Download the **Layer 1** mods from chapter 2 (cards link their own pages).
3. Unpack each download into the Mods folder you chose in Step 2 — a mod is typically a single `.dll` (plus optional subfolders); follow each mod's Files tab if it ships something else.
4. Launch the game and open the loader's mod menu: the mods should be listed. **Layer 1 first** — that is the save you start with.
5. When you later want Layer 2, open the mod menu and enable **Rivett Revamp** as well. The loader saves your enabled/disabled state per mod, so switching between the two layers is one menu visit.

Tip

Some mod pages still document **BepInEx** or **MelonLoader** installation routes from the game's early weeks. Ignore those — use the **MSCLoader** build of each mod (the Requirements tab lists the loader for every mod in this guide). One manager, one set of files, one update path.

1.5 Step 4 — Verify the first launch

1. Launch the game and load your save.
2. Confirm the mods are actually active — each mod card in chapter 2 says what you should see (Enhanced Graphics changes the sky and lighting immediately; the minimap adds its HUD; Better FPS can be benchmarked with `fpstest` in the loader console).
3. **If a mod has not been updated since the current game build**, watch for issues — see “Updating and removing mods” below.

Watch out

Backup your save folder (`%AppData%\LocalLow\Amistech\My Winter Car`) **before** installing anything, and again before any big change. Saves are two small text files — copying them is cheap, losing them is not.

1.6 Updating and removing mods

- **Update a mod:** the loader's mod menu has an **Updates** tab — it checks each enabled mod and applies updates from Nexus. If an update breaks something, check the mod's Posts tab for a fix before reporting it.
- **Remove a mod:** disable it in the mod menu, quit, delete its files from the Mods folder, and (for a mod that touches the car) load a save that doesn't rely on it.

- **Clean slate:** Steam → right-click My Winter Car → **Properties** → **Installed Files** → **Verify integrity of game files** resets the game’s own files. For the loader: reinstall it with MSCInstaller.exe and empty the Mods folder.
- **Bug reports:** the loader collects output_log.txt and MSCLoader_Preloaders.txt — attach both if a mod misbehaves and you report it to its author.

Good to know

Adding, removing or updating a mod is safe mid-career for this list — unlike many games, MSCLoader mods here do not touch the save format (the game’s progress lives in savefile.txt / carpart.txt, and none of the adopted mods rewrite them). Keep the backup habit anyway; Early Access patches are the real wildcard.

1.7 Safety rules

- Back up %AppData%\LocalLow\Amistech\My Winter Car before any big change, and keep a second backup when you start Layer 2.
- Read the **Requirements**, **Last updated** and **Bugs** fields on every mod page before downloading.
- Only install mods that list **MSCLoader (for My Winter Car)** as a requirement — My Summer Car mods do **not** magically work on My Winter Car (the loader can ignore its compatibility warning, but that “will NOT magically make MSC mods work on MWC”, per the loader’s own changelog).
- The moment something breaks: disable mods one at a time in the mod menu to isolate the culprit, then verify the game files.

2 The Modlist

What “Routa” actually consists of: My Winter Car v.260516-01 plus a curated MSCLoader modlist in two layers — and, just as importantly, what it deliberately leaves out.

2.1 The list at a glance

Property	Value
Base game	My Winter Car v.260516-01 (current Early Access build at guide time, August 2026)
Mod manager	MSCLoader (for My Winter Car) v1.4.2 — in-game mod menu + per-mod settings + updates
Layer 1 — “The Cold Start”	5 mods — QoL and graphics only; how a fresh player should start
Layer 2 — “The Full Winter”	1 mod added on top (Rivett Revamp) — the detailed, full modded experience; enable once you have experience
Distribution	Nexus Mods — official pages only
Playstyle	The vanilla sim, deepened and modernized — nothing that makes it easier

2.2 Design pillars

- **Deepen & modernize.** My Winter Car's January 1999 Finland is a survival sim and a project-car sim at once — the game's own 200+ part engine build, VIN-coded trims, inspections and races are the depth. This list makes the world look current, removes only genuine annoyances, and adds detail where the community has built it — it never moves the goalposts.
- **Graphics, honestly.** One serious visual overhaul (Enhanced Graphics) plus honest performance work. No fake “ultra” filters, and no second shader stacked on top just because it exists.
- **Details.** Physical touches a mechanic notices: a Corris that finally looks like the real Ford Taunus (Rivett Revamp), a headlamp for the dark garage, readable night traffic.
- **More AI, honestly.** My Winter Car's AI lives in its world: highway traffic, police checkpoints, taxi customers, NPC schedules. The only maintained AI-touching mods at guide time are behavioral tweaks — this list takes the good one (AI Highbeam Nerf) and says plainly that **no traffic-density or smarter-AI overhaul exists yet** for this young EA game. Pretending otherwise would be fiction.
- **No overpowered, no easier.** Nothing that raises money, spawns parts, or erases a mechanic the game teaches you by freezing your fingers off. Mods that do exactly that are listed at the end of this chapter with reasons.

2.3 The mod manager: MSCLoader (for My Winter Car)

MSCLoader is the community-standard mod manager for My Winter Car, and for an avid modder it is the only manager this guide uses:

- It **is** the ecosystem — 497 mods on the Nexus hub depend on it, so one manager covers everything: install, enable/disable, per-mod settings, auto-updates.
- Its **in-game mod menu** is how the two layers work: enable the Layer 1 set for your first save; add Rivett Revamp when you start Layer 2. No uninstalling, no file juggling.
- It gives every mod a **Mod Settings** page, an **Updates** tab, conflict warnings, and bundled bug reports (output_log.txt + MSCLoader_Preloaders.txt).
- It needs no third-party tools, no separate launchers, no account tricks — Nexus downloads, one installer, one folder.

Good to know

BepInEx and MelonLoader are **legacy** loader routes that a few early mod pages still document. They predate the loader's My Winter Car support and are not part of this guide — a mod's Requirements tab listing **MSCLoader (for My Winter Car)** is the filter every adopted mod passes.

2.4 Layer 1 — “The Cold Start” (QoL & graphics)

The starting set. Nothing here changes how the game plays — it makes it look better, run smoother, and removes only genuine annoyances of the dark Finnish winter.

2.4.1 Graphics

Enhanced Graphics v2.0

Visual overhaul · by JCSX11

The graphics pillar. Volumetric god-ray lighting on car lights, fully dynamic global illumination (SEGI), improved sun shadows and more shadow casters, a dynamic skybox system with separate day/night/rain exposure, better reflections, and car light & mirror enhancements (shadow casting, lens patterns). Wrapped in a full post-processing suite — anti-aliasing, ambient occlusion, depth of field, motion blur, bloom, sun shafts, color grading,

chromatic aberration, film grain and vignette — every effect individually configurable. v2.0 was a full rewrite that brought the game's look properly into the modern era.

Where: [nexus: mywintercar/mods/708](#)

Install: Download from Nexus, unpack into the Mods folder, enable in the loader's mod menu. Some options are marked performance-heavy — enable the helpers in the mod's settings first and switch effects on from there.

Risk: GPU-heavy effects can cost frames — the mod flags them, so tune rather than stack. Uses third-party and custom assets; if a game update breaks something, check the Posts tab for a fix.

Better FPS v1.3

Performance · by Bitpro17

A CPU-side optimization mod that rewrites parts of the game's code to faster equivalents while keeping functionality identical — the author describes it as 'inspired by Reharmonization' (the My Summer Car standard). Measured 6–46% FPS gains on his own saves. Honest about its limits: 'probably gives some FPS, probably doesn't break everything.' Benchmark it yourself by typing `fpstest` in the loader console.

Where: [nexus: mywintercar/mods/1060](#)

Install: Download from Nexus, unpack into the Mods folder, enable in the mod menu.

Risk: Low. CPU-only — no visual changes; if your game is GPU-bound or v-synced it simply won't do much, which is the point of the honesty.

2.4.2 Quality of life

GTA SA Style Minimap Vo.4.9

UI / navigation · by Snake04511

A full-screen world map and a circular HUD minimap. Press N for the full map (left-click to set a waypoint, right-click to delete), M to show/hide the minimap, with adjustable size, zoom and refresh rate. Overlay icons for the house, bar, gas station, mechanic and workplace, advertisement positions, and — the killer feature in January — taxi pickup/dropoff blips that only show *active* taxi jobs. Legend panel, dark mode, fully rebindable hotkeys.

Where: [nexus: mywintercar/mods/601](#)

Install: Download from Nexus, unpack into the Mods folder, enable in the mod menu. Configure hotkeys and icons via the loader's Mod Settings.

Risk: Low-to-medium. The author's own note: NOT compatible with the 'NOP' and 'Cold Start Fix' mods — neither of which this list adopts (see the rejected list).

AI Highbeam Nerf v1.0

AI behavior · by Tobipaste

Kills the 'AI highbeam flashbang': dims or completely disables AI high beams while forcing AI vehicles to keep their low beams on, with intensity sliders for both. Only touches AI traffic lights — your own cars are untouched. A genuine night-driving QoL fix for the dark season, and the only AI-behavior mod this list trusts.

Where: [nexus: mywintercar/mods/1184](#)

Install: Download from Nexus, unpack into the Mods folder, enable in the mod menu; recommended settings in the loader's Mod Settings: disable AI high beams ON, force low beams ON, low-beam multiplier 1.00.

Risk: Low. AI-only light objects; applies to newly spawned traffic too.

Head Lamp v1.0.1

QoL · by xVilho

A toggleable headlamp for the player (default G) — winter days are short and garages are dark, and the vanilla player carries no light. Fully configurable: color temperature (Kelvin), intensity, range and beam angle. One of the most-endorsed mods in the whole young hub, and exactly the kind of tool a mechanic would actually wear.

Where: [nexus: mywintercar/mods/68](#)

Install: Download from Nexus, unpack into the Mods folder, enable in the mod menu. The page documents a BepInEx route too — use the MSCLoader build (the Requirements tab lists the loader).

Risk: Low. A light source only; it does not change night darkness for the game world.

2.5 Layer 2 — “The Full Winter” (the full modded experience)

Once you have experience — a Rivett that runs, a job routine that works, a sense of the map — enable Rivett Revamp on top of the Layer 1 set. This is the layer for players who want the project car to look and feel like the real machine it is modelled on.

2.5.1 Detail & depth

Rivett Revamp v1.1.1

Vehicle detail overhaul · by michu97736 & Kwoniizin · the heart of Layer 2

A complete visual/detail overhaul of the Corris Rivett, making it look like the real 1971–76 Ford Taunus it is modelled on: remade body shape, realistic dashboard and interior parts, three headlight types and grilles to choose from, new rims and hubcaps, new fenders with trim, bumper options (including the GT rear bumper), side trims, a right mirror for prefacelift doors, seatbelts, headliner material selection, CD-player size and a subwoofer shelf, frozen-glass models, and license-plate options. Every option lives in the mod's settings menu. Nexus-tagged *Fair and balanced* — it adds detail, not power.

Where: [nexus: mywintercar/mods/2](#)

Install: Download from Nexus, unpack into the Mods folder, enable in the loader's mod menu; all options are set from the mod's settings menu.

Risk: Low-to-medium. Author-tracked quirks: the GT rear bumper collides with bumper-guard and rubber-side-stripe options, and the GT grille/bumper paint is buggy. If models glitch, delete `MeshSave` (the author's own fix).

Good to know

Layer 2 is deliberately one mod — and that is an honest statement about this game, not a shy one. My Winter Car is eight months into Early Access, and its mod scene is dominated by utilities and cheat tools (which this list rejects wholesale). The depth this layer promises — the 200+ part engine build, VIN-coded trims, strict ice-race inspections, tuning that can over-rev and wreck your own engine — is **already the base game**. Rivett Revamp is the first serious detail overhaul to land, and the moment real depth mods (traffic overhauls, wear systems, new parts) exist and are verified, this chapter grows. Until then, this list says what exists and what does not — that is the deal.

2.6 What we deliberately left out

Every mod below is real and several are enormously popular — and each one fails a pillar. The reasons are recorded in STATUS.md as well.

- **MWC CheatBox** — the hub's most-endorsed mod (1,183), Nexus-tagged **Cheating / Unbalanced / Unrealistic**: item spawner, godmode, money and bank editors, need locks, teleport and noclip, taxi income multipliers, time and weather control. It is the exact opposite of everything this list stands for — it erases the whole game.
- **ShowBoltSize** — shows the required wrench size and X-ray-highlights bolts. Choosing the right wrench by trial and error is a core hands-on mechanic of this series; showing the answer removes it. (The My Summer Car list reached the same verdict on the identical mod.)
- **MoonLightTweaks** — makes the night world brighter (default 2×). The short, dark Finnish winter is part of the game's challenge — the headlamp in Layer 1 is a tool **in** that darkness, not a removal of it.

- **My Winter Backpack** — carries multiple items at once, removing the one-thing-at-a-time friction. It is also **hidden on Nexus since April 2026** (unsupported by its author), so it fails the verifiable-source rule anyway.
- **JT Minimap** — the older, previously popular minimap; its author explicitly stopped supporting it. The maintained GTA SA Style Minimap covers the pillar.
- **“Cold Start Fix”** — a mod referenced by name in the minimap’s incompatibility note. It ‘fixes’ the game’s signature cold-start challenge — the exact challenge this guide’s chapter 3 teaches you to beat. Even setting compatibility aside, it fails the “no easier” pillar by design.
- **Traffic density / “more cars” mods** — none exist for My Winter Car at guide time. The AI pillar is served by the game’s own systems (traffic, checkpoints, taxi customers) plus AI Highbeam Nerf; when a maintained traffic mod lands, it gets a card.
- **Wear / dirt / rust visual systems** — none exist yet either. The detail pillar is Rivett Revamp plus the base game’s own wear and inspection systems.
- **BepInEx / MelonLoader loader routes** — legacy alternatives from the game’s first weeks; MSCLoader is the ecosystem and the only manager here.

Good to know

The line we draw: **friction you can feel is the game**. A headlamp for the dark garage deepens the work; a cheat box that spawns the parts you were meant to earn deletes it. Detail mods, honest performance work, and one serious graphics overhaul — that is what survives the winter.

2.7 Download sources

- Nexus Mods — My Winter Car hub: [nexusmods.com/mywintercar](https://www.nexusmods.com/mywintercar)
 - MSCLoader (for My Winter Car): [nexus: mywintercar/mods/3](https://www.nexusmods.com/mywintercar/mods/3) · github.com/piotrulos/MSCModLoader
- Every mod card above links its own Nexus page — check the **Last updated** and **Bugs** fields there before installing; the game is in active Early Access and versions move faster than any printed guide.

3 How to Play

A field manual for the modded My Winter Car: what the game is, how the January loop works, how to build and start a cold engine in -20°C , how to drive on ice — and what the mods change once you are in.

3.1 What the game actually is

My Winter Car is a **survival simulator and a project-car simulator at the same time**. You play the same nameless protagonist as in My Summer Car, back in the same region of rural Finland — Alivieska — in **January 1999**, when the markka is still the currency, the ground is frozen solid, and the sun barely shows up. Your needs are real: hunger, thirst, and above all **temperature**. Your project is real: a 1971–76 **Corris Rivett**, bought as a bare frame with a handful of loose parts and rebuilt by hand, bolt by bolt, into a car that passes inspection and wins races.

The core facts to hold onto:

- **You do not start with the project car**. You own a **Sorbet 1600 LTD** hatchback (the daily driver) and must earn the Rivett: it costs **500 mk** and is sold as a disassembled frame with 10–12 random loose parts in randomized condition.
- **Money is the pressure**. Jobs pay in markka; parts come from the **classifieds magazine** (ordered by phone), **Fleetari’s repair shop**, and the **flea market**.

- **Time advances in one-hour steps** and the winter day is brutally short. Planning the day matters more than reflexes.
- **The endgame is racing and restoration:** the **ice track race**, the **rally sprint**, and restoring the Rivett to its exact factory spec for **historic black-and-white plates**.

Tip

The game punishes the unprepared — that is the point and the fun. The mods in this list never remove that friction; they just make the world look and run better while you live in it.

3.2 The daily loop

A day in January Alivieska is a loop, and the order of the loop is the game:

1. **Wake up warm.** Check your needs — eat, drink, and get warm before stepping out. Cold drains you fast and kills outright if ignored.
2. **Earn.** Pick a job for the day: a factory shift at the **Futufon** charger-packing plant, a taxi fare, leaflet delivery, firewood for the elderly (with the **Kekmet** tractor), or flipping finds at the **flea market**.
3. **Spend smart.** Order the part you need from the classifieds (dial the number, listen — never hang up early), buy from Fleetari, or wait for a better deal.
4. **Build.** In the garage, work the car: bolts, gaskets, wiring, fluids. Every part you tighten is progress you can feel.
5. **Survive the night.** The dark is not decoration — it is cold, it is long, and your heater is the difference between a productive evening and a hospital bill (or worse).

Good to know

In Layer 1 this is exactly the vanilla loop, prettier and smoother. In Layer 2, Rivett Revamp makes the car itself a richer thing to build and admire. Neither changes the loop — the loop is the game.

3.3 Your first days in Alivieska

What to actually do with the first sessions, grounded in how the game's systems connect. Keybinds are the game's defaults — check Settings; mod-added keys are marked (mod).

Control (default)	What it does
W / A / S / D	Move; in a car, throttle / brake / steer
Mouse	Look; interact with objects, pick things up
E	Interact — open doors, use tools, enter vehicles, answer phones
NumPad	Dial numbers on the phone and classifieds order form
G (mod)	Toggle the Head Lamp on/off
N / M (mod)	Full-screen map / HUD minimap (GTA SA Style Minimap)
Mod menu (loader)	Enable/disable mods and open each mod's settings — keybind shown in the loader wiki

3.3.1 Day 1 — learn the house and the shop

1. You start in the apartment. Go through it: the fridge and stove feed you, the bed saves the game, and the **mailbox** outside collects your salary letter and classifieds.
2. Walk to the **PSK** (the village shop). It is your hub: groceries, fuel, tools, the **notice board** with job flyers, and the phone.

3. Read the notice board. The **Futufon factory** job is the reliable starting wage — you pack chargers on a shift, and the shift is real work with a schedule.

3.3.2 Day 2–3 — get the Sorbet working

1. Your **Sorbet 1600 LTD** is the daily driver — but it is January, and a car that has been sitting in the cold will not just start. Check its battery and fluids first; a warm garage helps enormously (a saved-while-cold car can lose accessory power until it thaws).
2. Refuel properly: **hold the mouse button** while the nozzle is in the tank — releasing early stops the pump.
3. Drive carefully: rear-wheel drive on snow and ice, short daylight. Use the minimap (Layer 1) to learn the roads before relying on them in the dark.

3.3.3 Day 4+ — buy the Rivett

1. Earn 500 mk. (This is the wall every player hits — see the economy section below.)
2. At the phone, dial **08609553** — Reijo Livaloinen. **Wait until he finishes talking and hangs up;** only then a pin appears on the map: “Car for sale”.
3. Bring it home. The **Kekmet** tractor’s fork is the recommended way (through the boot opening, tilt the fork up); the **Gifu** tow truck works under 40 km/h to avoid windshield damage; the trailer is slow but safe.
4. Now the project begins: inventory the frame and the 10–12 loose parts, order the rest from the classifieds, and start with the assemblies that make the car roll (see “Building the Rivett” below).

3.3.4 Day 5+ — the taxi (once the Rivett is yours)

After buying the Rivett, the notice board in the PSK carries the taxi flyer. Dial **08-712112**, then meet the taxi guy in the PSK parking lot at **12:00 the next weekday**. You become a taxi driver in a **Machtwagen** — a diesel Mercedes-W124-style taxi with a taximeter, a car phone, and a receipt printer. See the taxi section below for how the job actually works.

Watch out

The two classic ways to ruin a run: forgetting the passenger’s **luggage**, and hanging up the phone before the customer finishes speaking. Both lose you customers — the taxi owner will take the cab back if you get lazy.

3.4 The economy: jobs and money

- **Futufon factory** — the main job: packing chargers on a shift. Steady, honest, grindable. Your “second job” anchor early on.
- **Taxi** — the map-mastery job (detailed below). Pays 40% of the gross fare plus 3.7 mk per kilometer, minus phone expenses, paid to your bank account on **Wednesday at midnight**.
- **Leaflet delivery** — drive the routes, stuff the boxes. Pays per delivery.
- **Firewood** — the Kekmet tractor, a trailer, and the village’s woodpiles; cut, haul, stack.
- **Flea market** — buy low (classifieds, bargains), sell at the stall.
- **Septic orders, lottery, classifieds flipping** — the side economy. The classifieds magazine is also where car parts are ordered — it is the pipeline for your build, so read every issue.
- **The bank** — you have a bank account; check the interest rate on **Teletext page 172**, and remember salary lands Wednesday night.

3.4.1 The taxi job, properly

The Machtwagen is diesel, rear-wheel drive, and near-indestructible with half a million kilometers on it. The taximeter has five modes — this is your job:

- **Minus mode** — idle; you receive calls with the roof light on. Do not drive a fare in this mode.
- **Mode 1** — starting fare 21 mk; weekdays 06:00–18:00.
- **Mode 2** — starting fare 32 mk; weekdays after 18:00 and all weekend.
- **Mode A / B** — distance and income readouts.
- **Lotto mode** — generates lottery numbers from the taxi light button. It is a real feature; it does not do anything for the job.

Work flow: roof light on + minus mode → wait for the call → set mode 1 or 2, turn the roof light off → pick up passenger **and luggage** → drive to the destination → turn the roof light on, print the receipt, take payment → back to minus mode.

The dev-documented quirks are worth knowing: after loading a save, scroll the taximeter through mode 1 and 2 once before going back to minus mode, or customers never call. Never go to sleep with a customer in the car. You may drive 90% of your on-duty kilometers off-duty for free — exceeding that reduces your next payment. Keep sandbags in the trunk for traction, and give the diesel's glow plugs a moment before cranking.

Good to know

The taxi is the best map-teaching machine in the game: every fare is a real address on the map behind the sun visor, and by the time you have run thirty of them you know Alivieska's winter roads by heart. It is also the persona fuel for two of the five personas in chapter 4.

3.5 Engineering: building the Rivett

3.5.1 The engine, assembly by assembly

The community counts the Rivett's build at **well over 200 parts** — the engine alone is far more detailed than My Summer Car's. The engine is a **2.0-litre SOHC inline-four** (based on the Ford Pinto TL20H), making about 98 hp stock — low-revving, high-torque, rear-wheel drive. It is built in this order of assemblies:

1. **Short block** — the block itself, crankshaft, main and rod bearings, pistons, rings, connecting rods. Everything torqued, nothing left loose.
2. **Cylinder head** — head gasket (never reuse a damaged one), head, valves, springs, and the valve adjustment that is a classic first-build failure point.
3. **Timing** — timing belt and covers; the Rivett's belt cover famously still said "1600 SOHC" for the first weeks after launch.
4. **Ancillaries** — oil pump, water pump, alternator (which has its own friction and horsepower draw), starter, fuel pump, carburetor, radiator and its fan.
5. **Fuelling & spark** — lines, the single-barrel carburetor (or the high-performance two-barrel on sporty trims), ignition timing, and the **carburetor mixture** — community wisdom puts the cold-start A/F area in the 12–15 range, and a wrong mixture is the classic "built it right but it won't run" cause.

The whole car follows the same logic: **chassis** → **suspension (springs, shocks)** → **brakes (lines and all)** → **driveline (gearbox, differential, axles)** → **engine** → **body panels** → **electrics** → **interior**. Every assembly has gaskets, nuts, and bolts that simply must be there — the wiki and the Steam guide "Rivett Parts List" are the checklists you will live by on your first build.

Watch out

The most common "why won't it start" causes, in order: a missed gasket or loose bolt in the intake, the carburetor mixture wrong for the cold, a dead or cold-soaked battery, no fuel (fuel tank door left closed, empty tank), and — new in winter — **the engine itself being frozen**. Diagnose in that order.

3.5.2 Bolts, tools and the feel of the build

Every bolt has a size and a tool; you will learn the sizes by working, and the wrench rack in the garage is your memory. Two golden rules:

- **Tighten everything you touch.** Loose bolts rattle, leak, and fail inspection. Torque to the sound and feel — the game rewards deliberate work.
- **Carry spares of the small things.** Starters die (you will hear the tell-tale “Ruscko noise” when it is time to replace it) — the community standard is to collect starters from mailboxes and keep one in the trunk.

3.6 The cold start (the signature skill)

Starting the Rivett in January is the game’s most famous mechanic, and it is teachable. The engine has a hidden “CarbChamber” value (0–30) that a running engine holds near 15.75; **above 17.75 the car will not start below freezing**. If the Rivett refuses to start, that value is probably maxed at 30 — reset it by disconnecting the carburetor from the engine and saving/loading. The reliable cold-start procedure, from the game’s wiki:

1. Turn on the ignition and **hold the gas (W)**. Turn the headlights off if you like — it helps the battery. Do **not** pull the choke yet.
2. Crank the starter for 4–5 seconds, keeping the gas pedal fully down. This drops the CarbChamber to roughly 13.
3. Release ignition and gas. Pull the choke fully out, then push it back in a **millimeter below** the maximum position.
4. Hold the ignition again — no gas, or at most one or two short taps.
5. The engine starts within a few seconds. Immediately move the choke to the middle and keep touching the gas to hold the revs; if it stalls, it likely will not restart — the CarbChamber has climbed to 18 and the battery lost half its charge.
6. Once warm, retract the choke fully. A strange number on the mixture gauge is your reminder.

Tip

This procedure is reliable outdoors down to about **−26°C**. Below that, take the **Sorbet** — with a **block heater** connected it is the honest answer to extreme cold. And store the Rivett in the warm garage: saving it in a cold place can leave it without accessory power until it thaws.

3.6.1 Oil, battery, and the redline

- **Motor oil** matters in winter: white oil for short commutes; blue oil protects better on long runs but damages parts (especially the oil filter) during cold starts; **redline oil is only for engines that actually live at the redline**. If you lower the rev limiter from 8900 to 6900, you do not need it.
- **Do not rev a cold engine.** Cold, thick oil does not lubricate — the game will damage the engine if you drive hard before it warms up.
- **Over-revving above about 9100 RPM damages engine components.** Once you start tuning, a rev limiter is not a luxury — it is a spare engine.
- **The battery is the cold’s first victim.** Heated garage storage is the best “mod” in the game; a spare battery and a good alternator (see the 2026 patch notes — the alternator’s power draw is real) keep the daily driver honest.

3.7 Winter driving

- **Rear-wheel drive on snow and ice** understeers into ditches: drive in the highest gear that pulls, brake early and straight, and **add weight over the driven axle** — the taxi tradition of sandbags in the trunk applies to the Rivett too.
- **Diesel takes a moment** — the Machtwagen's glow plugs need a beat before cranking.
- **Police checkpoints** patrol the highway; wear your seatbelt (the taxi fines you for not wearing one — the police logic was patched in May 2026), mind your lights, and know that a fine hits the bank account.
- **The ice track** is a real race surface on the lake — studs and a tuned car are the difference between winning and spinning. The ice-track inspections are **strict** (they were tightened in the January 2026 patch), so bring a properly built car, not a hopeful one.

3.8 Inspection, racing and historic plates

- **Inspections** gate your progress: the Rivett must pass before serious racing. Everything matters — bolts, brakes, lights, bodywork, trim correctness.
- **Two races matter:** the **ice track race** on the frozen lake and the **rally sprint** — the Rivett is the only car eligible for both. The GT trim's high-performance engine, LSD, quick steering and tachometer cluster are the factory head-start; aftermarket cams, carbs and the 5-speed gearbox are the tuner's path.
- **Historic plates:** restore the Rivett to its exact **factory-original** specification — VIN-correct seats, instrument panel, rims, every VIN-listed part, all in good condition — and it can be registered as a historic vehicle with special black-and-white plates. The VIN plate lives under the hood on the front right; decode it at amistech.com/mwc/vinplate.html (the dealer options sheet is at amistech.com/mwc/dealersheet.html). This is the completionist endgame, and it demands the discipline the whole game teaches.

3.9 Music, mail and small pleasures

- **Custom music is vanilla:** put .ogg files named track1.ogg, track2.ogg... into the game's CD1, CD2, CD3 folders and use **Import Music Files** on the main menu; the CDs appear in your house and play on the home stereo or the car's CD player.
- **Mail matters:** salary rundown letters and classifieds arrive in the mailbox; read them.
- **Teletext** has the bank page, and the lottery runs on real draws — a Lotto-mode taxi fare line is a free ticket.

3.10 The modded experience

What the two layers change once you are playing:

- **Enhanced Graphics** — the frozen lake, the long sunsets, the headlights in the dark: all simply look right. If frames drop, disable effects one at a time in the mod's settings before blaming the game.
- **Better FPS** — the sim stays smooth where it used to chug; test it yourself with `fpstest` in the loader console.
- **GTA SA Style Minimap** — the map becomes a tool: waypoints for taxi fares, icons for the shop and mechanic, taxi blips for active jobs. The winter roads stop being guesswork.
- **AI Highbeam Nerf** — night driving stops being a strobe show; AI traffic keeps its low beams and your eyes keep working.
- **Head Lamp** — work on the car after dark without squinting; the beam is configurable in the loader's Mod Settings.
- **Rivett Revamp** (Layer 2) — the Corris looks like the real Taunus: proper dash, proper grilles and lights, proper bumpers. All options are in the mod's settings menu; build your car, then make it **yours**.

3.11 Basic terms

Term	Meaning
mk	Markka — the currency of January 1999 Finland. The Rivett costs 500 mk.
Sorbet 1600 LTD	Your starting daily-driver hatchback; the dependable one, and the one with the block-heater option for extreme cold.
Corris Rivett	The 1971–76 project car — Ford Taunus TC1 styling, 2.0L SOHC inline-four, RWD. Bought as a bare frame for 500 mk and built by hand.
VIN	The chassis code on a plate under the hood (front right) that encodes trim, options and year; the Rivett’s spec is chosen at game start and decoded at amistech.com/mwc/vinplate.html .
Trim (L / LX / SLX / GT)	Factory equipment levels: base L, premium LX, luxury SLX, and the rare sporty GT with the high-performance engine, LSD and tachometer.
Historic plates	Black-and-white plates earned by restoring the Rivett to its exact factory VIN spec, all parts in good condition.
CarbChamber	The engine’s hidden fuel-chamber value (0–30); a running engine holds 15.75, and above 17.75 the car will not start below freezing.
Choke	The manual enrichment control on the dash — the heart of the cold-start dance.
Block heater	An electric engine heater for the Sorbet; the honest answer below –26°C.
Glow plugs	The diesel Machtwagen’s pre-heating element; give them a moment before cranking.
Ruscko noise	The sound a dying starter makes — the community’s tell that it is time to replace it.
PSK	The village shop — groceries, fuel, tools, notice board and phone: your hub.
Fleetari	The repair-shop owner; a source of parts, and the gatekeeper of some repairs.
Classifieds magazine	The mail-order parts catalog — dial the number, place an order, wait for delivery. Never hang up early.
Futufon	The charger-packing factory — the reliable main job.
Machtwagen	The taxi: a diesel Mercedes-W124-style car with taximeter, car phone and receipt printer.
Kekmet	The village tractor — fork, bucket, and the best way to move a Rivett shell without breaking glass.
Gifu	The tow truck; towing the Rivett works under 40 km/h if you value the windshield.
Ice track / rally sprint	The two endgame races, both Rivett-only: the frozen-lake ice race and the rally sprint.
Jokkis	The Finnish hobby-racing scene the game’s race cars come from — “folk racing” in spirit.

Teletext	The in-game information pages (the bank's interest rate lives on page 172).
Mods folder	Where MSCLoader loads mods from — one folder, chosen at loader install, usually the game folder.
Mod menu / Mod Settings	The loader's in-game interface for enabling mods and configuring each one.

3.12 Saves, backups & troubleshooting

- **Saves live in** %AppData%\LocalLow\Amistech\My Winter Car — savefile.txt (world state, player stats, jobs) and carpart.txt (vehicle wear and tightness). Copy the whole folder for a backup; it is two small text files.
- **Mod problems:** check the mod's **Last updated** date first — an Early Access game update is the usual culprit. Then check the mod's Posts tab; then disable mods one at a time in the mod menu to isolate.
- **Loader diagnostics:** the loader writes output_log.txt and MSCLoader_Preloaders.txt next to the game's executable — attach both when reporting a bug.
- **Cold-start mystery:** if a built engine simply refuses to start, reset the CarbChamber (disconnect the carburetor, save/load) and re-run the procedure — and check the battery charge first.
- **Crashes or weirdness:** Steam → Verify integrity of game files resets the game; reinstall the loader with MSCInstaller.exe and empty the Mods folder for a clean slate.

3.13 How to get good (a checklist)

- Master the Sorbet's winter routine before touching the Rivett — the daily driver is your teacher.
- Read every classifieds issue; the parts pipeline is the build.
- Work the factory shift early and the taxi routes later — one teaches discipline, the other teaches the map.
- Build the engine in assembly order and tighten **everything**; the Rivett Parts List guide is the checklist.
- Learn the cold-start procedure until it is reflex — it is the game's hardest and most rewarding skill.
- Store the car warm, carry a spare starter, and never rev a cold engine.
- Drive like it is January: early braking, weight over the driven axle, seatbelt on.
- In Layer 2, take your time with Rivett Revamp's options — build the car, then make it yours.
- When a race fails or an inspection catches you, the car is usually the problem. That is the game working as intended — fix the car, not the rulebook.

4 Personas

Five ways to survive January 1999 — each with a background, the game choices that make it yours, and the mods that fit.

4.1 Before you start: how “game creation” works here

My Winter Car has no character creator — no name, no face, no skill points. You play the game's protagonist, and your identity is what you **decide**. The game gives you real levers, and every persona below pulls them differently:

- **The car plan.** Do you nurse the Sorbet and grind the Rivett in parallel, or buy the Rivett shell the moment the markka allows and live on the build site? The 500 mk purchase is a persona-defining decision.
- **The money path.** Factory shifts, taxi routes, firewood, flea-market flipping — the job mix is your character sheet.

- **The house rules.** What you may buy vs. what you must find, what counts as winning, whether death is reloadable. Difficulty comes from the rules you keep.
- **The mods.** Layer 1 for the first run; Layer 2 (Rivett Revamp enabled) once you have experience. Personas differ in goals and rules, not in the mod list — every persona plays the same two layers.

Good to know

All five personas run on the same installation — they differ in strategy, jobs, house rules and goals, not in the mods available. Start a separate save per persona and keep one backup per save.

4.2 1. The Assembly Mechanic

The Assembly Mechanic

Difficulty: medium · Focus: the build

Background. You apprenticed under a village mechanic for seven winters and you believe every car is a story written in bolts. You are not racing anyone — you are restoring the Corris Rivett the way it deserves: VIN plate decoded on day one, every factory option catalogued, every gasket replaced, every torque felt. The classifieds are your reading material and the garage is your office. The ice race can wait until the car is *right*.

Game creation choices

- **Car plan:** Sorbet stays the reliable earner while the Rivett is bought early and built in strict assembly order. No part fitted before its assembly is complete.
- **Money path:** steady Futufon shifts + classifieds ordering; the taxi only when the build budget demands it.
- **House rules:** VIN-correct parts only until the historic restoration is complete; nothing aftermarket that the factory didn't offer — the GT-listed options are the only exceptions; every assembly tested (engine on the stand, brakes before body panels) before moving on.
- **Goal:** a factory-correct Rivett registered with **historic black-and-white plates** — and only then, a tuned variant for the ice track.
- **Mods that shine:** Rivett Revamp (the dash, grilles and bumpers you are restoring finally look right), Enhanced Graphics (the garage at night is the room you live in), Head Lamp, Better FPS, GTA SA Style Minimap (part-hunting routes).

4.3 2. The Taxi Man

The Taxi Man

Difficulty: medium · Focus: the map and the fare

Background. Laid off from the Futufon line, you answered the classified ad and found your calling behind the wheel of a half-million-kilometer diesel Mercedes. You know every house, every pothole, every shortcut in Alivieska — the sun visor map is memorized, not consulted. You drive the night shift for the better fare, and the meter is your meditation. The Rivett is the retirement plan you are building one fare at a time.

Game creation choices

- **Car plan:** buy the Rivett as soon as the taxi job is secured (it unlocks the taxi), then build it slowly in the evenings between shifts.
- **Money path:** the taxi is the whole economy — mode 2 fares, weekend doubles, luggage always loaded, the 90% free-driving allowance honored to the meter.
- **House rules:** every fare completed, no customer refused; the 40% + 3.7 mk/km arithmetic is the score; the taxi's diesel and sandbags are non-negotiable expenses; no save-scumming a bad fare.
- **Goal:** 100 fares, the map memorized cold, and a Rivett that passes inspection with the taxi's earnings — then the rally sprint, driven like a cabbie (smooth, early, safe).

- **Mods that shine:** GTA SA Style Minimap (taxi blips show **active** jobs — the persona's native tool), AI Highbeam Nerf (night shift survival), Head Lamp (picking up fares after dark), Enhanced Graphics, Rivett Revamp.

4.4 3. The Factory Hand

The Factory Hand

Difficulty: medium · Focus: survival and the wage

Background. You are not here to restore a museum piece — you are here to survive January and build a car that runs. The Futufon shift is the spine of your day: punch in, pack chargers, punch out, eat, sleep, repeat. You spend what you earn on exactly two things — parts and warmth. No lottery, no luxury, no debt. The Rivett gets built in the hours the factory leaves you, and every bolt is one bolt closer to a car that owes you nothing.

Game creation choices

- **Car plan:** the Sorbet is maintained religiously (it is the income stream); the Rivett is bought from the first 500 mk surplus and built cheapest-first — whatever makes it start and roll.
- **Money path:** Futufon shifts first; leaflet and firewood jobs on days off; classifieds only for parts the flea market can't supply.
- **House rules:** one day of work, one day of build, every week; needs met before pleasures — warm food, warm garage, sleep; if a part is too expensive this week, it waits — no debt, no shortcuts.
- **Goal:** a running, inspected Rivett and a healthy bank balance — the quiet win of the disciplined earner.
- **Mods that shine:** Better FPS (the long shifts are sim-heavy), GTA SA Style Minimap (commute and errands), Head Lamp, Enhanced Graphics, AI Highbeam Nerf.

4.5 4. The Ice Racer

The Ice Racer

Difficulty: hard · Focus: the frozen track

Background. You grew up on the jokkis circuit — lawnmower engines in clapped-out shells, frozen lakes, and the smell of studded tires on black ice. The Rivett is not a restoration project, it is a *race car waiting for its body*. You bought the cheapest shell you could find, you will bin the VIN in favour of the GT spec, and the tuning notes on the kitchen table are your gospel: cam, carbs, rev limiter, weight over the driven wheels. The inspection is a speed bump, not a standard.

Game creation choices

- **Car plan:** buy the Rivett fast, strip it to the shell, and build for the GT spec: high-performance engine, LSD, quick steering, lowered springs, tachometer cluster, studs for the ice.
- **Money path:** the fastest-paying grind you can stomach — taxi doubles and firewood contracts; parts budget goes to performance, not polish.
- **House rules:** over-revving is a choice, not an accident — you set the rev limiter low and respect it, or you pay for the engine; every race entry must pass inspection first (the ice-track inspections are strict since the January patch); weight, balance and studs are tuned per track, not once.
- **Goal:** win the **ice track race** and the **rally sprint** in a car you built and tuned yourself.
- **Mods that shine:** Rivett Revamp (the GT grille and bumper, the dash you are racing with), Enhanced Graphics (night practice sessions), Better FPS (clean sim at speed), GTA SA Style Minimap, AI Highbeam Nerf.

Watch out

The Ice Racer is the high-risk persona: tuning a Pinto past its limits is exactly how engines die above 9100 RPM. The rev limiter is a budget item, not an accessory — this persona respects it, and so should you.

4.6 5. The Hermit of Alivieska

The Hermit of Alivieska

Difficulty: very hard · Focus: the land and the cold

Background. You came back to the family property after years away and found the world has moved on without you — good. You live small: firewood cut with the Kekmet, a garden of flea-market bargains, and a bank account you distrust. The Rivett is not a car, it is a *winter project* — it gets built when the day's heat is secured, and not a markka before. You play with the house rules the game cannot enforce: death is permanent, debt is shame, and comfort is a luxury you earn in firewood.

Game creation choices

- **Car plan:** the Sorbet is the only machine you trust; the Rivett is bought last, from surplus, and built at the pace of the seasons.
- **Money path:** firewood contracts, flea-market trading, classifieds arbitrage — the wage jobs are the fallback, not the plan.
- **House rules: death is permanent** — no reloads, no cheats, no shortcuts; never spend more than half the bank balance in a day; every purchased part must be justified by a full tank and a warm house first; sleep before midnight, work before noon.
- **Goal:** a historic-plate Rivett and a full winter survived without a single reload — the purest version of the game.
- **Mods that shine:** Head Lamp (the dark is real for this persona), GTA SA Style Minimap (scouting the map's edges), Enhanced Graphics (the frozen world is the point), Better FPS, AI Highbeam Nerf, and Rivett Revamp — when the hermit finally finishes the car, it deserves to look finished.

Watch out

The Hermit is the hard mode of this list — everything is a resource, including warmth. If a run stops being fun, soften one house rule; the persona is a lens, not a vow.

4.7 How to start a persona run

1. Choose your layer: Layer 1 (new player) or Layer 2 (fresh save, experience under your belt — enable Rivett Revamp in the mod menu).
2. Start a new game and spend the first days as the persona's money path dictates.
3. Write your house rules somewhere visible — three lines on paper beats a forgotten promise in the dark.
4. Keep one backup of the persona's save folder (%AppData%\LocalLow\Amistech\My Winter Car) per persona.
5. Play the persona's priorities from day one — the build order, the job mix, and the goal are the identity.

Persona	Difficulty	Signature mods
The Assembly Mechanic	Medium	Rivett Revamp, Enhanced Graphics, Head Lamp, Better FPS, Minimap
The Taxi Man	Medium	Minimap (taxi blips), AI Highbeam Nerf, Head Lamp, Enhanced Graphics, Rivett Revamp

The Factory Hand	Medium	Better FPS, Minimap, Head Lamp, Enhanced Graphics, AI Highbeam Nerf
The Ice Racer	Hard	Rivett Revamp, Enhanced Graphics, Better FPS, Minimap, AI Highbeam Nerf
The Hermit of Alivieska	Very hard	Head Lamp, Minimap, Enhanced Graphics, Better FPS, AI Highbeam Nerf, Rivett Revamp